ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 16: **Political Parties (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** Indian National Congress	It is a centrist party
2	**(a)** Some are all-India in outlook but succeeded only in a few States	Samajwadi Party and RJD have organisations in several States
3	**(b)** more people reporting membership of parties over three decades	Membership and closeness to parties went up
4	**(d)** It makes dissent within a party more difficult	MPs must accept the party leaders' decisions
5	**(b)** dynastic succession	Top positions controlled by a family
6	**(c)** no one could promise major policy changes and no one would be responsible for running the country	The chapter's argument for parties
7	**(c)** Aam Aadmi Party	It formed a government with the support of the Congress
8	**(d)** lack of internal democracy	Concentration of power
9	**(b)** petrol, paper and telephone	Cash may be given on the basis of votes in the last election
10	**(c)** Parties may find ways to cheat the law	Political parties will not pass a law they do not like

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Some are all-India parties that succeeded in only a few States (1); Parties like SP and RJD have units in several States (1).	1+1
12	Parties reflect existing social and political divisions (1); They also group opinions and form governments (1).	1+1
13	Only a handful are in the race to win (1); More than 750 are registered but few are serious contenders (1).	1+1
14	To reduce reliance on rich donors (1); To limit the influence of money in elections (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Social and regional diversity is large (1); Many parties represent different groups (1); Coalitions share power (1).	1+1+1
16	Parties need funds for elections (1); Donors expect influence on policies (1); Parties pick candidates who can raise funds (1).	1+1+1
17	Leaders take decisions and direct (1); Active members work for the party (1); Followers support it and vote (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Parties present in only one unit and parties in several units (1); National parties follow policies decided nationally (1); State parties focus on regional identity (1).	1+1+1
18	It evolves over a long time (1); Depends on social and regional divisions, history of politics, system of elections (1); It cannot be changed quickly (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Anti-defection reduced defection but limited dissent (1); Affidavit gave information but is unchecked (1); Election Commission order may be a formality (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Visible, so blamed for what goes wrong (1); Associated with divisions and scandals (1); Yet perform functions needed in democracy (1); Little trust but high participation (1); Without them no one would be responsible (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Anti-defection law reduces defection but restricts dissent (1); Affidavit: information available but unchecked (1); EC order on elections and tax returns: partly formality (1); Over-regulation may be counter-productive (1); Parties may resist laws they dislike (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Candidates who can raise money are nominated (1); Companies and rich people influence decisions (1); Parties support criminals who can win (1); Affidavit system is a partial remedy (1); State funding could help (1).	1+1+1+1+1

	OR: BSP: 1984, Kanshi Ram, bahujan samaj, UP (1); BJP: 1980, integral humanism, expanded in the 1990s (1); CPI-M: 1964, Marxism-Leninism, West Bengal, Kerala, Tripura (1); INC: 1885, secularism, welfare (1); AAP, NPP are recent (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Confusing the three party systems: **one-party** (China), **two-party** (USA, UK) and **multi-party** (India).
- Writing that a recognised **national party** is decided by the government; it is the **Election Commission** that recognises parties by their vote share and seats.
- Forgetting that parties also do work other than contest elections: **make laws, shape public opinion, form and run the government, act as opposition** and run welfare schemes.
- Mixing up the party's **symbol** with its **flag**; the Election Commission allots election symbols.
- Treating the **anti-defection law** as a law that stops parties from forming coalitions; it stops legislators from changing sides after being elected.
- Listing the challenges as 'too many parties' only; the NCERT challenges are **lack of internal democracy, dynastic succession, money and muscle power and lack of meaningful choice**.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 16: **Political Parties (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** shaping public opinion and opposing the government	Parties launch movements for people's problems
2	**(c)** It often appears messy and leads to instability	But it allows variety of interests
3	**(a)** CPI-M	Among the poor, factory workers and farmers
4	**(a)** does not meet the criteria of a national party	At least four Lok Sabha seats are needed
5	**(c)** opposing the government	Opposition parties mobilise against government policies
6	**(b)** He loses his seat in the legislature	Anti-defection amendment
7	**(a)** There is no system to check if the information is true	The public gets information, but its truth is unchecked
8	**(c)** No national party could secure a majority in Lok Sabha on its own	Coalitions became necessary
9	**(a)** Its social and geographical diversity	It is not easily absorbed by two or three parties
10	**(c)** National People's Party	It formed a government in Meghalaya

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	They stand for a part of the society (1); They take a side on issues (1).	1+1
12	An alliance is formed to contest elections (1); A coalition government is formed by parties together after winning (1).	1+1
13	Parties lack internal democracy and women are under-represented (1); A quota of about one-third tickets for women (1).	1+1
14	It is neither rightist nor leftist (1); It supports secularism and welfare of weaker sections (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Played a dominant role for decades after Independence (1); Ruled the Centre till 1977 and from 1980 to 1989 (1); After 1989 its support declined but it continues across the country (1).	1+1+1
16	Quality of democracy depends on participation (1); Reform is hard when people only criticise from outside (1); Bad politics can be solved by better politics (1).	1+1+1
17	Major parties agree on fundamental aspects (1); Differ in details of implementation (1); Those wanting different policies have no option (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Few ways for an ordinary worker to rise (1); Leaders favour family members (1); People with little experience get power (1).	1+1+1
18	Even in non-party elections, factions form (1); Each faction puts up a panel (1); This is what parties do (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Different views exist on what is good for all (1); Each party persuades people that its policies are better (1); It stands for a part of society (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	No membership registers or elections (1); Members cannot influence decisions (1); Leaders gain unchecked power (1); Family members favoured (1); Dissenters find it hard to stay (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Functions: contest elections, put forward policies, make laws, form government (1); Opposition, shape opinion, provide access to schemes (1); Challenges: lack of internal democracy and dynasty (1); Money, muscle power (1); No meaningful choice (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Rise of State parties over three decades (1); No single party majority until 2014 (1); National parties allied with State parties (1); Since 1996 almost every State party was part of a coalition (1); Federalism and democracy strengthened (1).	1+1+1+1+1

	OR: Internal democracy: law to regulate internal affairs (1); Dynasty: open and transparent procedures (1); Money and muscle: state funding, affidavits (1); Meaningful choice: genuine policy differences (1); Citizen pressure and participation (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Confusing the three party systems: **one-party** (China), **two-party** (USA, UK) and **multi-party** (India).
- Writing that a recognised **national party** is decided by the government; it is the **Election Commission** that recognises parties by their vote share and seats.
- Forgetting that parties also do work other than contest elections: **make laws, shape public opinion, form and run the government, act as opposition** and run welfare schemes.
- Mixing up the party's **symbol** with its **flag**; the Election Commission allots election symbols.
- Treating the **anti-defection law** as a law that stops parties from forming coalitions; it stops legislators from changing sides after being elected.
- Listing the challenges as 'too many parties' only; the NCERT challenges are **lack of internal democracy, dynastic succession, money and muscle power and lack of meaningful choice**.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 16: **Political Parties (Political Science)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** the growing role of muscle power	Parties focus only on winning
2	**(c)** top party leaders	A difference in methods
3	**(a)** lack of meaningful choice	They cannot pick very different policies
4	**(c)** Bharatiya Janata Party	As per the chapter
5	**(b)** CPI-M	It supports socialism and opposes imperialism and communalism
6	**(c)** running government and welfare schemes	Parties provide access to schemes
7	**(d)** State party	It meets the State party criteria
8	**(c)** the village splits into factions just as parties do	Parties are a natural result of differing opinions
9	**(d)** NDA - Bharatiya Janata Party	Alliances of 2004
10	**(d)** Sahu Maharaj, Phule, Periyar and Ambedkar	It seeks to secure interests of the dalits and oppressed

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	It groups similar opinions together (1); It supports a few basic positions (1).	1+1
12	They must hold organisational elections (1); They must file income tax returns (1).	1+1
13	They disclose property and criminal cases (1); Truthfulness is not checked (1).	1+1
14	Members who defy the party lose their seat (1); They must follow party leaders (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	National parties needed alliances with them (1); State parties joined national coalitions since 1996 (1); Parliament became more diverse (1).	1+1+1
16	BJP: cultural nationalism, integral humanism (1); INC: secularism and welfare of weaker sections (1); INC is centrist; BJP is associated with cultural nationalism (1).	1+1+1
17	Different States have different party systems: two-party, multiparty with two alliances, multiparty (1); Party system varies by State (1); National pattern is multiparty (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Earlier limited to north and west and urban areas (1); Expanded to south, east, north-east and rural areas (1); Came to power in 1998 leading the NDA (1).	1+1+1
18	Parties must be significantly different (1); Voters must have real alternatives (1); Leaders should not keep shifting between parties (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It checks the government (1); It offers alternatives to voters (1); It voices different views (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Registered with the Election Commission (1); Recognised party gets a symbol (1); State party: 6 per cent votes and two seats (1); National party: 6 per cent votes in four States and four Lok Sabha seats (1); AAP, BSP, BJP, CPI-M, INC and NPP (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: Group opinions into basic positions (1); Voters choose among policies (1); Government bases policy on the ruling party's line (1); Members follow party leadership in legislature (1); Opposition criticises policy (1).	1+1+1+1+1
20	Petitions, publicity and agitations (1); Media and movements can pressure (1); Joining parties (1); Demanding transparency (1); Voting wisely (1).	1+1+1+1+1
	OR: One-party: not democratic, China (1); Two-party: USA, UK (1); Multiparty: India, with alliances (1); Multiparty is messy but representative (1); Party system depends on society (1).	1+1+1+1+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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